

How We Figure Out Everyone's Odds

Football 2026 — Week 3 Picks Pool — written so anyone can follow it, no math background needed. Every number below is real and comes straight from this week's actual data.

1

Where the numbers come from

We don't guess, and we don't use a website's own computer prediction. We use the **real odds from DraftKings**, an actual sportsbook where real people bet real money on these games. If a game's odds are wrong, real bettors would be losing or winning money over it — that keeps the numbers honest.

2

Turning odds into a percentage

Sportsbooks show odds as a “moneyline” — a number like -225 or +185. A **minus** number means that team is expected to win (the bigger the number, the more likely). A **plus** number means they're the underdog.

The formula:

Favorite (minus number): $\text{chance} = \text{odds} \div (\text{odds} + 100)$

Underdog (plus number): $\text{chance} = 100 \div (\text{odds} + 100)$

Real example from this week — Philadelphia @ Chicago: CHI is +185, so its raw chance is $100 \div (185 + 100) = 35.1\%$. PHI is -225, so its raw chance is $225 \div (225 + 100) = 69.2\%$.

Add those two up: $35.1\% + 69.2\% = 104.3\%$ — more than 100%! That extra bit is the sportsbook's own cut for running the bet (called the “vig”), and it's not a real chance of anything — we take it back out by dividing each number by the total:

CHI = $35.1\% \div 104.3\% = 33.6\%$ • PHI = $69.2\% \div 104.3\% = 66.4\%$

Now they add up to exactly 100% — that's the fair, honest percentage we actually use for that game.

3

Replaying the week 20,000 times

Think of it like hitting “restart” on a video game, over and over. Each time, the computer decides every undecided game — but not by flipping a fair coin. It rolls a **loaded die** weighted to match that game's real percentage from Step 2, so a 66% favorite really does win about 66 times out of every 100 pretend replays. Games that have already actually finished always come out the same real way — no re-rolling those.

After each pretend replay, the computer checks everyone's picks against that replay's results and writes down: who got the most correct? That's the “winner” of that one replay.

Your Win% is simply: out of all 20,000 pretend replays, in how many of them were you the winner (or tied for it)? If you won 1,200 of the 20,000 replays, your Win% is $1,200 \div 20,000 = 6\%$.

4

Breaking ties with the tiebreaker number

Sometimes two or more people are tied for the most correct picks in the same pretend replay. When that happens, whoever's tiebreaker number guess is **closest to that replay's combined score** of the Monday Night game (PHI vs. CHI) wins that replay instead of splitting it.

Since that game hasn't been played yet, each replay also has to imagine a realistic final score for it. We use the sportsbook's own point spread (PHI by 4.5) and total (46.5 combined points) to center a believable guess, then add a little random wobble — real NFL scores aren't perfectly predictable, so neither is our pretend one.

Exactly where this comes from, no hand-waving:

- **Odds:** DraftKings sportsbook lines, via ESPN's odds page, fetched fresh at the start of each week and updated as games are actually played.
- **The simulation:** a real computer program (Python), 20,000 random trials, run fresh every time this page updates — nothing here is picked by hand.
- **This snapshot:** generated 7:09 PM ET, Thursday September 24.
- **What it can't know:** injuries or news that happen after the odds were fetched, and it treats every game as independent (no weather affecting two games at once, etc.).